Who is India's strongest bank?

An audit-grade scorecard of State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank, FY2022–FY2026 | 10 October 2026

Position

ICICI Bank leads the FY2022-FY2026 scorecard with a mean score of 66.2, against 61.1 for HDFC Bank and 27.4 for State Bank of India. The two leaders are strong in different places: ICICI on asset quality (77.9 against 55.7 and 35.8) and HDFC Bank on profitability (65.8 against 55.9 and 20.0). The merger-clean window of FY2024-FY2026 gives the same winner at a wider margin - ICICI 81.5, SBI 45.6, HDFC Bank 35.2.

The ranking is not an artefact of the chosen weights, but it is conditional on them. Re-drawing the pillar weights 10,000 times from a uniform distribution over the weight simplex puts ICICI Bank first in 69.7% of runs and HDFC Bank in 30.3%, while State Bank of India ranks third in every single one. The condition is measurable: ICICI keeps the lead for any asset-quality weight above 0.22, and raising the profit pillar above 0.56 hands it to HDFC Bank. Efficiency carries no data for any bank and contributes nothing.

One qualification governs every figure above. The ICICI return figures were read by hand from the annual reports, its net profit was read from chart coordinates and is confirmed by up to five of its own reports, and the remaining cells are machine-extracted and not yet checked line by line against the pages they cite. Six ICICI cells are still blank. The numbers are reported because the pipeline is complete and reproducible, not because the extraction is finished.

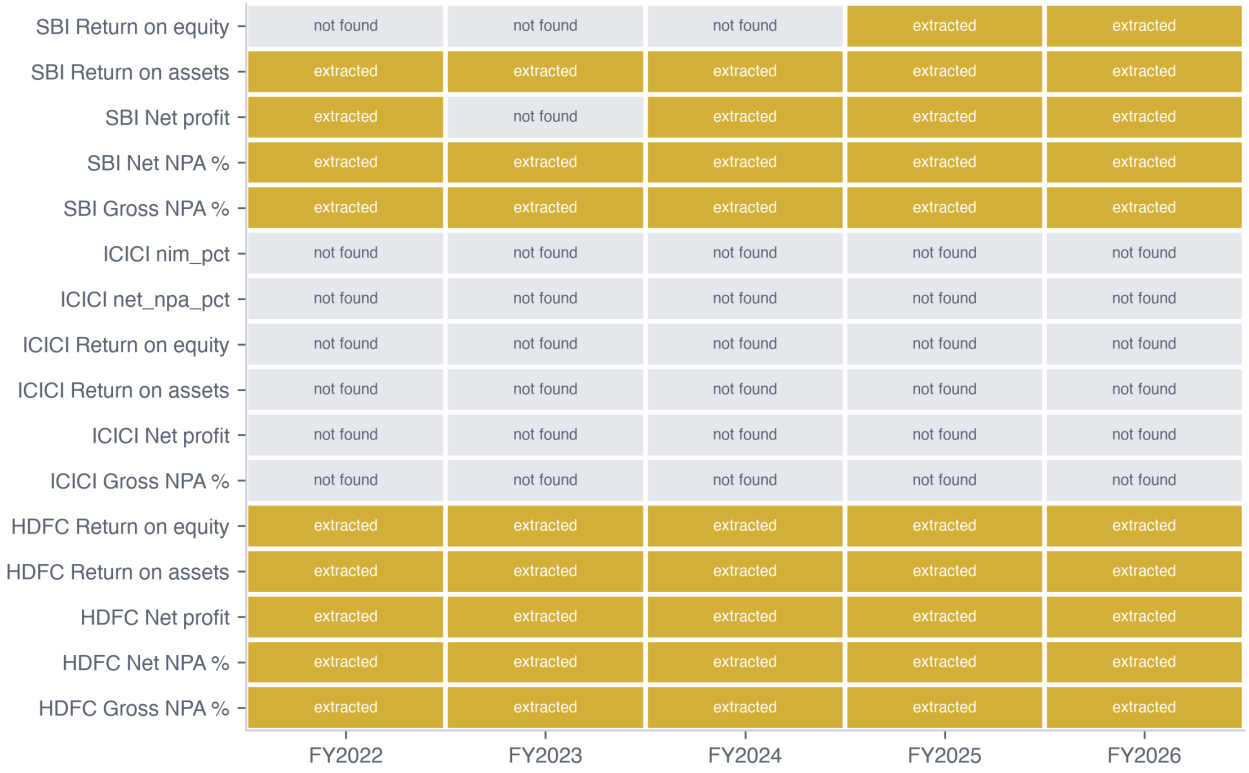
Method

- **Sources.** Twenty-one primary documents - annual reports, quarterly results and investor presentations for the three banks, FY2022 to FY2026 - downloaded by hand where the issuers block automated retrieval.
- **Extraction.** Full text is pulled from every page (5,220 pages) and each metric is located by labelled pattern matching, with the document, page and matched line recorded against every value.
- **Verification.** Each candidate carries a status. Only values a human has checked against the source are marked verified; nothing machine-extracted is trusted by the scoring layer.
- **Validation.** Hard checks run before any scoring: net NPA may never exceed gross NPA, return on equity must exceed return on assets within a plausible leverage band, no financial year may be missing from a started series, and no currency amount may enter the score.
- **Scoring.** Metrics are oriented so higher is better, normalised 0-100 within each year across the three banks, combined into three pillars (asset quality 35%, profitability 40%, efficiency 25%), then re-drawn across 10,000 random weightings to test whether the leader survives a change of assumptions.

Verification coverage by bank, metric and year

Data verification coverage

What exists, what is machine-extracted, and what is still missing



Where the evidence stands

Bank	Metric	Years with a value	Scoring-eligible
HDFC	Gross NPA %	5	5
HDFC	Net NPA %	5	5
HDFC	Net profit	5	0
HDFC	Net interest margin	0	0
HDFC	Return on assets	5	5
HDFC	Return on equity	5	5
ICICI	Gross NPA %	0	0
ICICI	Net NPA %	5	5
ICICI	Net profit	5	0
ICICI	Net interest margin	5	5
ICICI	Return on assets	4	4
ICICI	Return on equity	5	5
SBI	Gross NPA %	5	5
SBI	Net NPA %	5	5
SBI	Net profit	5	0

Scoring-eligible counts values that are both present and verified. It is zero throughout the current dataset, which is why no score has been produced.

Risks and limitations

- **Cross-bank definition risk.** Provision coverage, cost-to-income and margin denominators are defined differently by different banks and are flagged rather than harmonised.
- **Merger distortion.** HDFC Bank absorbed HDFC Ltd on 1 July 2023; FY2024 contains roughly nine months of the combined entity. Every time series marks this, and a merger-clean window is reported alongside the full one.
- **Source availability.** ICICI Bank's annual reports for this period present ratios graphically, so those cells are recorded as not found rather than estimated.
- **Extraction risk.** Pattern matching over 5,220 pages can capture a segment figure or mis-date a multi-year row. This is precisely why machine output is never scored without review.
- **Scope.** Standalone financials only, no valuation, no forecast and no view on the securities.

Document appendix

Documents used
HDFC_FY22_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY23_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY24_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY25_AR.pdf
HDFC_FY26_AR.pdf
ICICI_FY22_AR.pdf

Documents used
ICICI_FY23_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY24_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY25_AR.pdf.pdf
ICICI_FY26_AR.pdf.pdf
SBI_FY22_AR.pdf
SBI_FY23_AR.pdf
SBI_FY24_AR.pdf
SBI_FY25_AR.pdf
SBI_FY26_AR.pdf

15 source document(s). Each extracted value records its document, page number and SHA-256 of the file it came from, in data/source_log.csv.

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